

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'The Radiance of the Pure, Stainless Ray of Light'

Ārya-raśmi-vimala-viśuddha-prabhā-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 510 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་འདོ་ཟེ་དཀྱི་མདེ་པ་རྣམ་པར་དག་པའི་འདོ་ཅས་བ་བྱའ་གི་བྱུངས།

Toh 510 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-raśmi-vimala-viśuddha-prabhā-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Pakpa Özer Drima Mepa Nampar Dakpé Ö, meaning "The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'The Radiance of the Pure, Stainless Ray of Light.'" It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and presents a sacred incantation concerned with the power of pure, radiant light, framed within a discourse delivered by the Buddha at the great city of Kapilavastu before an assembly of monks, bodhisattvas, and a host of divine and semi-divine beings. The text opens by noting that it was extracted from a larger work, the Bodhyagryābharaṇaśatasāhasra, suggesting it originally formed part of a much more extensive collection. The gathering of prominent bodhisattvas such as Avalokiteśvara, Mañjuśrī, Vajrapāṇi, and Maitreya points to the Mahāyāna character of the text, situating it within the broader tradition of dhāraṇī literature aimed at invoking protective and purifying spiritual power.

This concludes the dhāraṇī of the hundred thousand, extracted from the Bodhyagryābharaṇaśatasāhasra.

In the language of India: Ārya-raśmi-vimala-viśuddha-prabhā-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The noble dhāraṇī called "The Radiance of the Pure, Stainless Ray of Light."

I bow down to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One (the Buddha) was dwelling together with a great Saṅgha of monks and with a vast multitude of great bodhisattvas in the great courtyard of the palace in the great city of Kapilavastu. Among them were the great bodhisattva Sarvanivaraṇaviṣkambhin, Vajrapāṇi, the noble Avalokiteśvara, Mañjuśrī, Prajñāloka, Maitreya, and countless other great bodhisattvas, as well as gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (scent-eaters), asuras, garuḍas (sky-soaring birds), kinnaras (semi-human beings), great serpents, humans, and non-humans — an innumerable multitude who had arranged themselves respectfully before the Blessed One, paying homage, circumambulating him, and showing him reverence as he sat teaching the Dharma.

At that time, there was a great brahmin living in the city of Kapilavastu named Kapilavastu-moon, who had no faith in the Blessed One's teaching and held wrong views. One night he dreamed a dream of another kind, and in that dream he heard a voice saying: "Great brahmin, you have seven days remaining before the time of your death arrives." The brahmin was deeply dismayed and, seized by terror, he thought to himself: "Now I must seek a refuge for my life. I have heard it said that the ascetic Gautama is omniscient and endowed with miraculous powers. I shall go to him. Even if he truly is omniscient, perhaps, out of compassion for those who are afflicted with inner fear, he will not fail to teach the Dharma and will provide me refuge."

And so he went to the presence of the Blessed One. When he was still some distance away, he saw the Blessed One seated together with a great retinue. Not daring to speak to the Blessed One, he sat there agitated in his mind. But the Blessed One — the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, knowing the three times, seeing all, free of all obscuration — perceived the brahmin's state of mind and, moved by loving-kindness and compassion, spoke:

"Great brahmin, seven days from now, having met with death, you will be reborn in the lower realms, the wretched destinies — in the Avīci hell (the hell of unceasing torment). From there, you will pass in succession through the sixteen great hells. When you are freed from those, you will be born into a body of base and lowly birth. After dying from that, you will be reborn in the body of a pig, constantly eating foul and unclean matter, dwelling for a long time in mire and filth, and continually experiencing suffering. Then, even if you should obtain a human body, you will be extremely poor, unclean, foul-smelling, ugly and dark in complexion, with a rough and puny body, and afflicted with leprosy. You will be repulsive to all people, constantly tormented by hunger, despised by all, perpetually beaten and abused, and you will suffer greatly."

Upon hearing these words, the brahmin was stricken with extreme terror. Overwhelmed with anguish, he prostrated at that very moment at the feet of the Blessed One with his head upon the ground and implored him:

"Blessed One, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas are the protector and refuge of all sentient beings. I am one who has accumulated every manner of sinful action.

From this day forward, may the Blessed One be my protector and refuge from the suffering of birth in the lower realms, the evil destinies, and the hells."

When the brahmin had spoken these words, the Blessed One declared: "Great brahmin, go now. At the crossroads on the road to the city of Śrāvastī there stands an old and crumbling stūpa that contains bone-relics. Restore that stūpa, and upon its pinnacle set an axial pole. Write this mantra down and place it inside, then offer worship before it and recite the mantra seven times. Your lifespan, which had been exhausted, will be replenished and extended. After the time of your death you will be born in the higher realms of fortunate destinies, in places of great enjoyment and abundance, and for a hundred thousand great eons your enjoyment of happiness will likewise be renewed and will flourish and grow. After that you will be born in the pure buddha-field of the Tathāgata Akṣobhya, and for many hundreds of thousands of eons you will experience supreme great bliss. Then, passing from there, you will be reborn among the gods of the four great kings, and there too, for a hundred thousand great eons, you will experience inexhaustible enjoyment and happiness. In every place where you are born throughout your lifetimes you will be at ease and your life will be free of obstacles. All karmic obscurations will be exhausted, and you will never again fall into the hells, evil destinies, or lower realms. You will constantly meet perfectly and fully awakened buddhas as they appear, and they will hold you in their compassionate care."

"Great brahmin, further: if any monk, nun, layman, laywoman, son of good family, or daughter of good family has a short lifespan or is afflicted by many illnesses, let that person repair an old stūpa or build a new one, write this mantra, place it within, sweep and adorn a maṇḍala, and make offerings. The benefits are these: a lifespan that had been spent will be replenished and lengthened; one who is seized by illness and suffering will be liberated from all disease; and never again will such a person be born in the lower realms, the evil destinies, the hells, in the realm of animals, or in the world of Yama, Lord of Death. If even the sound of those names will not reach their ears, how much less will they take birth in such states."

When the brahmin heard these words he was filled with great joy. Resolving to repair the damaged stūpa, he rose from that assembly and departed.

Now at that very moment in that same assembly, the great bodhisattva named Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin rose from his seat, joined his palms, and addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, how should this mantra ritual be performed so that it will produce qualities, excellence, and the roots of virtue?"

When he had so asked, the Blessed One declared: "This teaching called Vimalaprabhā — the Immaculate and Pure Radiance — supreme among all the great mantras, the most exalted in its very nature: when it is performed according to the rite of the great maṇḍala, it will bring benefit and happiness to all sentient beings through the blessings of all the Tathāgatas. For those who hear this mantra, even the sins of having committed the five acts of immediate retribution will be entirely and without remainder purified. All unwholesome roots — miserliness, covetousness, jealousy, and the like — will likewise be purified. A lifespan that had been exhausted will be extended; and every auspicious and excellent perfection will be accomplished."

When the Blessed One had so declared, the great bodhisattva Sarvaṇīvaraṇaviṣkambhin again addressed the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, we implore the Blessed One, for the protection of the lives of all sentient beings and for the removal of all karmic obscurations, to please declare this complete ritual of the secret mantra to this entire assembly."

When this was said, the Blessed One gave his assent. A great radiant effulgence of light rays arose from the uṣṇīṣa atop the Blessed One's head and illuminated all the world-systems of the great trichiliocosm with that light. All the Tathāgatas were also made aware of it. Then those rays of light gathered back and dissolved into the uṣṇīṣa atop the Blessed One's head.

Thereupon the Blessed One, joyful and in a voice melodious as the kalavinka bird, declared the secret mantra:

Namaḥ saptānāṃ samyaksambuddhakoṭīnāṃ pariśuddhe manasi
abhyarcitapa tiṣṭhatunāṃ namo bhagavate amṛtāyusaḥ tathāgatasya oṃ
sarvatathāgataśuddhi āyurviśodhane saṃhara maṃhara
sarvatathāgatavīryabalena pratisaṃhara āyusārasāra sarvatathāgatasamaya
bodhaya bodhaya mama sarvapāpam āvaraṇaviśuddhe vigatamalam
carasubaddha buddhe huru huru svāhā.

This is the root mantra. For whoever wishes to perform the ritual of this mantra, on any one of the eighth, thirteenth, fourteenth, or fifteenth day of the lunar month, one should circumambulate a relic stupa seventy-seven times and recite this secret mantra seventy-seven times. One should perform ablution and draw a maṇḍala, then inscribe the letters of the secret mantra seventy-seven times. At that time, the one reciting the mantra and the one writing the letters should both have bathed and put on clean clothes, anointed the body with incense, eaten pure food, and made offerings of flowers and

incense. One should offer to it the seven kinds of precious substances as a gift offering, or alternatively offer whatever one can afford from one's own means — the essential point is that the offering be made with a joyful heart. For the sake of venerating the Dharma, one should perform prostrations and make a great rendering of the image. Regarding the letters of the secret mantra as well, one should regard them as rare and precious. One should erect seventy-seven stupas of whatever size one is able, large or small, and within each one should place the secret mantra. If one then makes great offerings with a one-pointed mind, a lifespan that has been exhausted will be restored and life will be prolonged. All sins and karmic obscurations accumulated over innumerable past lives will be entirely purified, and one will never again be reborn in any of the states of hell-beings, animals, or hungry ghosts. Moreover, in every place of rebirth, one will recall all previous lives. Every thought and intention that arises in the mind will likewise be accomplished. The roots of virtue of seventy-seven hundred thousand Tathāgatas will be generated. And one will be liberated from all illness and suffering.

If someone has been struck by severe illness and has reached the point of death, one should make a square maṇḍala. Upon it, using five kinds of pigment, one should draw the following figures: in the center, a wheel, a vajra, a conch, a trident, a svastika, and lotus flowers. On each of the four corners one should draw a lotus, and upon each of those one should place a vase filled with scented water, one at each of the four corners. One should also set there a censer filled with various types of incense burning together. In vessels of the five colors one should place various foods: the three white foods combined with rice porridge. Also, small bowls filled with scented water, flowers, and either fruit or grain, as well as torma cakes prepared with various foods combined together with a full vase of scented water, should be placed upon the maṇḍala.

Beside that torma cake and the rice, one should draw an image of the lord of the assembly and place a butter lamp upon the crown of that image. Then one should seat the patient to the west of the maṇḍala, and place an offering of refreshment before the patient who is facing inward toward the maṇḍala, and present it as an offering.

Next, the mantra-reciter, having made himself very pure and clean, should recite the secret mantra seventy-seven times over the patient. If this ritual is performed in this way, and the patient's life-force is exhausted and he is approaching the time of death — even if within seven days he has become

confused in his mindfulness and is in a state of delusion — his life will be restored and he will come to live long. He will not experience the sufferings of nightmares.

If someone, having made himself very pure and clean, recites the secret mantra once each and every day without interruption for as long as he lives, then when he comes to the time of death, he will be born in a place of inexhaustible enjoyment and happiness. If one recites continuously at all times, one will be born in a pure land where buddhas dwell, and will come to remember one's past lives as well. Untimely death and all obscurations will be purified.

Furthermore, if anyone who wishes to benefit a deceased person recites the secret mantra seventy-seven times from the depths of his heart, then even if that deceased person has fallen into a lower realm (naraka), in that very instant his karmic obscurations will be exhausted and he will be born among the gods of the higher realms and will experience happiness.

Furthermore, if anyone writes the secret mantra in letters, mentions the name of another person, places it inside a stūpa, and makes earnest offerings there, then whoever that deceased person may be, he will be liberated from the lower realms and be born in the higher realms. Or he may be born among the class of gods of Tuṣita heaven, and by the blessing of the buddhas will not fall into the lower realms.

If any son or daughter of noble lineage circumambulates that stūpa, or prostrates before it, or makes offerings to it, then by the blessing of the Tathāgata, they will become irreversible from the path of unsurpassable awakening. All karmic obscurations accumulated in past lives will be entirely purified without remainder.

Even birds and deer and other animals upon whom the shadow of that stūpa falls — they too will never again be born in the lower realms such as the animal realm. Even one who possesses the great evil of the five heinous acts, if he merely touches that stūpa or is merely touched by its shadow, all his misdeeds will be purified and exhausted entirely.

Spirits (bhūtas), yakṣas, rākṣasas, hungry ghosts, flesh-eaters, and other beings that enter into bodies and cause harm — as well as ferocious predators, falling thunderbolts, venomous evil serpents, contact poisons, and all such dangers — will find no foothold and will cease to exist in the place where that stūpa stands. Moreover, enemy armies and weapons, fire, water, hail, famine,

untimely death, evil dreams, inauspicious omens, and all the harms of suffering will be no more.

If an evil omen should arise in that land, through the blessing of the stūpa and the buddhas a great radiance will burst forth, and all evil omens and inauspiciousness will be averted. If some other person with malicious intent plans to cause harm through armies and thieves, or if an enemy aggressor arises, then at that place a great radiance will emanate from that stūpa, and through the miraculous power of the Tathāgata, surrounded on all sides by blazing tongues of flame, armies with their forces and a rain of weapons will be made manifest, and all the enemy host will be pacified and made to turn back. The gods too will protect and guard the place,

and within a boundary of one hundred leagues in all four directions, no strife, no contagious disease, and no sickness among livestock whatsoever will arise. Conflict and dispute will not occur, and conduct contrary to the Dharma will cease. No other mantra can cut through or suppress this stūpa, for this mantra is the root of all mantras.

Now the mantra of the life-pillar of that stūpa is taught:

Oṃ sarva tathāgata vipula yaṣṭi maṇi kanaka rājata vipuṣita yaṣṭi dhuru dhuru samante pilokite sara sara mama sarva pāpa viśodhani saṃbodhani pravar yaṣṭi parimaṇi duṣṭa huru cira mala viśuddhe hūṃ hūṃ svāhā.

O son of good family, by all means write this mantra carefully, ninety-nine times in letters, and insert it into the four faces of the life-pillar of the stūpa. Likewise write out this very ritual text and insert it inside the life-pillar. If the ritual is performed in this way, it is equivalent to having erected the life-pillars of ninety-nine thousand stūpas. Beyond that, it is equivalent to having erected ninety-nine thousand stūpas containing relics. Beyond that still, it is equivalent to having constructed ninety-nine thousand stūpas of seven precious substances. And beyond even that, by virtue of the meritorious act of making offerings to the Tathāgata, it is equivalent to having built ninety-nine thousand stūpas in a temple as magnificent as the celestial court before the god Dharmabhadra.

Furthermore, if someone makes even a small stūpa from clay and places these mantras inside it, that too is equivalent to having erected ninety-nine thousand stūpas of seven precious substances. And if someone circumambulates this stūpa, pays homage, joins their palms, offers flowers, applies perfume, offers incense, or presents even a few bells, banners, or

parasols, that too is equal in merit to having offered all of these to the stūpas of ninety-nine thousand Tathāgatas. One will attain the splendor of the complete fulfillment of all roots of virtue along with great power and strength. Even if a bird or a bee is merely touched by the shadow of that stūpa, the Tathāgatas will know it and hold it in their compassionate care. Such a being will attain unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening and will abide on the stage of non-regression.

Furthermore, if someone dreams of such a stūpa, or sees it from afar, or hears the sound of its bell, or merely hears a report that such a stūpa is being erected — even those persons will be purified of all the five acts of immediate retribution and all other sins and obscurations, and they will always be guarded and held in the compassionate care of the Tathāgatas, and they will attain the completely purified path of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

This mantra is called the Mantra of the Life-Pillar of the Stūpa.

Furthermore, O son of good family, this is the heart essence of those mantras for the construction of stūpas of the Tathāgata:

Oṃ sarva tathāgata mala viśodhani rudhya balepa pratisaṃskāra
tathāgatadhātu dhare dhara dhara sandhara sandhara sarva tathāgata
adhiṣṭhāna adhiṣṭhite svāhā.

Whether it be a monk, a nun, a male lay practitioner, or a female lay practitioner — if someone builds a stūpa themselves, or has one built by others, or even repairs and restores an old stūpa — whether it be a small stūpa made of clay, or of brick, or of stone — they should first recite the heart mantra one thousand and eight times,

Then, whether the stūpa built after the mantra is applied be the size of a fingernail, or the size of a cubit, or even as much as a league in measure — through the power of the secret mantra and the strength of one-pointed mind, that stūpa will exude the fragrance of incense: the scent of sandalwood, camphor, musk, saffron, and other such perfumes will rise from it, as will the sweet fragrance of divine incense. Every intention of those who perform the work of the stūpa and those who recite the mantra — whether for themselves or others — will be fulfilled just as they wish. They will accumulate a vast root of virtue, and will also obtain excellence and an abundance of good qualities. Even if they carry the karma of a short life, their life will lengthen and grow long. At the moment of death, they will behold buddhas in their billions —

ninety-nine hundred million million buddhas — and those Tathāgatas will regard them with care. In their next birth they will be born in a perfectly pure buddha-field, and will receive a direct prophecy there. In that pure field they will be capable of sustaining a life of ten million hundred thousand billion years. They will obtain the recollection of former lives, the divine eye, and the perfectly pure divine ear; they will obtain knowledge of others' minds, and knowledge of death and rebirth. From their body the fragrance of sandalwood will arise, and from their mouth the scent of blue lotus will issue forth. Having attained the path to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, they will also attain the stage of non-regression.

Moreover, even so little as a mustard-seed's worth of perfumed ointment — if one recites the secret mantra over it and anoints the stūpa with it — one will obtain all those same qualities and excellences just as described before.

Furthermore, any monk, nun, male lay practitioner, or female lay practitioner who purifies themselves and then takes up these words of the secret mantra as something rare and precious should have faith in them as they would in a Tathāgata, generate reverence for the mantras, and write them down. Having written the mantras and mudrā rites in the manner described above, they should insert that heart essence at the base of the life-tree of the stūpa and then build the stūpa. By doing so they will accumulate a vast root of virtue and will obtain all excellence and good qualities.

Then, when the Blessed One had finished teaching these mudrā rites of the secret mantra, all the Tathāgatas dwelling in the world-realms of the ten directions were filled with joy and declared: "It is well, it is well, that the perfectly and completely awakened Śākyamuni, regarding all sentient beings with impartiality and establishing everything in the dharmadhātu, has shown how the blessing of the mudrā rites of the great secret mantra is to be obtained. Most excellent indeed! Through those roots of virtue, unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening will be attained, and one will become irreversible."

Then, in that very maṇḍala of the assembled retinue — gods, nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, gandharvas, asuras, kinnaras, and great serpents (mahoragas) gathered together, along with the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, the four great kings, Brahmā the forefather who protects the world, Viṣṇu, the Great God (Śiva), Śakra (Indra), Yama, the water deity Varuṇa, Kubera, and other gods of great miraculous power — all of them, upon hearing what the Blessed One had

taught, became wearied and disenchanted with their own respective domains. Wishing to obtain those great qualities in the end, they called out to one another and said:

"Alas! The arising of a perfectly and fully awakened buddha is exceedingly rare. To hear the holy Dharma of his teaching is also exceedingly rare. To hear the teaching of a perfectly and fully awakened buddha on the assembly of secret mantras and mudrās is exceedingly rare indeed. This is most wondrous!" So they said.

Then at that moment a brahmin named Serkyi Dawa (Golden Moon) who, having heard and received from the Blessed One those great qualities of secret mantra and ritual just described, found himself separated from the dust and turbidity of mental obscuration. All fear of death, all wrongdoing, and all karmic obscurations were entirely purified. His life was restored and lengthened, and he became filled with joy and delight, attaining great mental happiness. Then all the assembled beings likewise rejoiced in their minds and in every field.

Thereupon the great bodhisattva Sarvanivaraṇaviṣkambhin, in order to make offering to the Tathāgata, manifested through his miraculous power a jeweled palace decorated with varied precious gems, and, out of joy in the Dharma, offered it to the Blessed One. He then circumambulated three times, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, and addressed him with this request:

"Blessed One, you have taught — for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings, for the sake of those beings of Jambudvīpa who are heavily obscured — these supremely rare secret mantras, mudrās, and maṇḍala rituals, causing virtuous roots to arise, granting long life, and liberating from every mass of suffering. Therefore here and now we bodhisattvas too petition all the buddha Blessed Ones, and we ask that, in the presence of the Tathāgata, the mudrā and the words of the secret mantra for accomplishing authentic wisdom be spoken."

Namo bhagavate, nava-nava-tīnām,
samyaksaṃbuddha-koṭi-niyuta-śata-sahasrāṇām. Namaḥ
sarva-nivaraṇa-viṣkambhini bodhisattvāya. Oṃ turu turu mama
sarva-āvaraṇa-viśodhani, sarva-tathāgata-āyur-balāni, vipulani-ramale,
sarva-siddhi namaskṛtvā, vara vara, sarva-sattva-avalokini. Oṃ
sarva-nivāraṇa-viṣkambhiṇi, mama sarva-pāpa-viśodhani kuru svāhā.

"Blessed One, this my secret mantra was taught by nine hundred and ninety million buddhas. If anyone recites it even once with an undistracted, one-pointed mind, all wrongdoings will be entirely purified.

Furthermore, if anyone writes this secret mantra ninety-nine times according to the ritual and places it inside a stūpa, then if anyone else bows to that stūpa, praises it with pleasing words, or offers incense, flowers, perfume, or lamps — that son of a noble family will, in this very life, be entirely purified of all wrongdoings and have all karmic obscurations removed, and every wish will be fulfilled just as desired. It will be equal to having made offering and rendered reverence to hundreds of thousands of countless buddha Blessed Ones as numerous as the grains of sand of the Gaṅgā River. Likewise it will be equal to having made offering to hundreds of thousands of billions of stūpas enshrining relics, as many as the sands of the Gaṅgā. The virtuous roots accumulated thereby will be immeasurably vast.

Moreover, if any renunciant practitioner (śramaṇa), on the eighth, fourteenth, or fifteenth day of the month, bathes and cleanses himself, wears clean robes, and either fasts for one day, or takes the three white foods, and then circumambulates a stūpa while reciting this secret mantra one hundred and eight times — all karmic obscurations accumulated over hundreds of thousands of eons, and all..."

the five acts of immediate retribution will also be completely purified. Furthermore, once all obscurations of karma and mental afflictions have been thoroughly cleansed, the bodhisattva Remover of All Obscurations will manifest in his own bodily form, granting the accomplishment of all aspirations, and one will behold the faces of all perfectly and fully awakened buddhas.

Likewise, whoever recites this mantra two hundred and eight times will attain meditative absorption. Whoever recites it three hundred and eight times will be purified of all obscurations and will come to abide on the stage of non-return. Whoever recites it four hundred and eight times — the four great kings of the four great royal lineages will draw near and manifest in bodily form, guard and protect that person, arouse the power of wisdom, and accomplish all merit on their behalf. Whoever recites it five hundred and eight times will, by those very roots of virtue, attain abiding on the unconditioned path. Whoever recites it six hundred and eight times will become a bearer of vidyā-mantras and will travel to the realm of the knowledge-holders in the sky.

Whoever recites it seven hundred and eight times in full will come to possess all excellent qualities. Whoever recites it eight hundred and eight times will attain independence from the direction of others, and the mind will become thoroughly pure. Whoever recites it nine hundred and eight times will have the five aggregates thoroughly purified. Whoever recites it one thousand and eight times will attain the fruit of stream-entry. Whoever recites it two thousand in full will attain the fruit of once-returning. Whoever recites it three thousand in full will attain the fruit of non-returning. Whoever recites it four thousand in full will attain the fruit of the arhat. Whoever recites it five thousand in full will attain what a pratyekabuddha attains. Whoever recites it six thousand in full will attain the miraculous powers of a bodhisattva. Whoever recites it seven thousand in full will attain the first ground of a bodhisattva. Whoever recites it eight thousand in full will traverse the fifth ground of a bodhisattva. Whoever recites it nine thousand in full will attain the body of the lord of vidyā-mantras and secret mantras, the body of the Secret One. Whoever recites it ten thousand in full will traverse the eighth bodhisattva ground, the Immovable. Whoever recites it twenty thousand in full will attain the body of the unsurpassed, perfectly and fully awakened buddha and will roar the great lion's roar.

Moreover, if anyone wishes to perform meritorious deeds for the sake of their parents, they should restore and repair an ancient relic stūpa that has fallen into ruin, circumambulate it clockwise, and recite the mantra until they have completed one hundred and eight circumambulations with recitations — all their aspirations will be fulfilled just as they wish.

Thereupon the Blessed One praised the bodhisattva Remover of All Obscurations with the words: "Excellent, excellent! O son of good family, you have been my companion and have expounded correctly, in precise accordance with the ritual of the Tathāgata's secret mantras."

Then Vajrapāṇi, the lord of all yakṣas and master of secrets, addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, since this sovereign of secret mantras and these mantra rituals are equal to the Tathāgatas and arise from the dharmakāya of the Tathāgatas — Blessed One, may these supreme essences, for the sake of sentient beings dwelling in Jambudvīpa, purify the karmic obscurations..."

...and having thereby cleared away all sins, one will thenceforth enter into the teaching of the Blessed One.

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke to the master of secrets: "O master of secrets, these mantra rituals will be, even in times to come, equivalent to a Tathāgata dwelling in the world. If, performed in accordance with the ritual as I have taught it, even a small karmic application yields great results and abides in great benefit, what then need be said of a great karmic application? All roots of virtue will thereby be accumulated. For this reason, their qualities could not be fully described even by as many hundreds of thousands and tens of millions of Tathāgatas as there are grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā — only those Tathāgatas themselves could know and see them."

The master of secrets asked: "Blessed One, what small and easy thing should one do in order to attain a great meritorious fruit and obtain great merit?"

The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, listen well — I shall explain. Whatever monk, nun, layman, or laywoman desires to obtain a great meritorious fruit and qualities: let him or her perform the ritual of the sovereign of secret mantras as taught before. Having written it in ninety-nine syllables and fashioned a square maṇḍala before a buddha stūpa, smear it with cow-dung. Place one vessel filled with perfumed water at each of the four corners. Place also a censer with slowly smouldering incense. Into a great vessel, pour flowers, perfumed water, and dried grain, and set these upon the maṇḍala. Then mix together black sesame, green lentils (māṣa beans), and rice and cook them into the rice porridge called kṛsara; add to this the three white foods. Pour all of this into a vase. Further, arrange upon the maṇḍala ninety-nine fruits of various trees, the named foods mentioned here, incense, flowers, and so forth. Place the syllables of the secret mantra inside the life-pillar of the stūpa. Then, vividly holding in mind all the Tathāgatas of the ten directions arrayed at the four sides of the stūpa, offer them reverence, and with one-pointed mind recite these secret mantras:

Oṃ vipula vimale pravarejina vare sara sara sarva tathāgata dhātu garbhe adhiṣṭhite svāhā āyatato bani svāhā sarva devāni vahaya vibuddha adhiṣṭhāna samaye svāhā.

Let the smoke of the incense rise without interruption, and recite the secret mantra twenty-eight times. At that very moment, eight great bodhisattvas (mahābodhisattvas), eight great yakṣa commanders, the master of secrets, the four great kings, Brahmā, the Great Lord (Maheśvara), and the sons of Mṛtyu will come to that stūpa, make offerings to it, perform its service, and stabilize its life-pillar.

Beyond that even, ninety-nine hundred-thousandfold tens of millions of buddhas, and as many as there are grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā, will come to that place, make offerings to that stūpa, bless it as a dharmakāya, and cause it to become endowed with relics.

If in this way the ritual is performed correctly and from the heart, one will obtain all those qualities — and moreover, one will obtain merit equal to that of a stūpa built from wish-fulfilling jewels (cintāmaṇi), equal to having built stūpas from hundreds of thousands and tens of millions of manifold forms of precious substances. One will be endowed with vast roots of virtue, one's body will be utterly pure, one's life long, one will be free of illness, and no obstacle-makers whatsoever will be able to harm one.

Furthermore, if someone merely sees this stūpa, or even hears the sound of its bell, all karmic obscurations and every sin will be purified. Even one who has committed the five acts of immediate retribution will be completely purified and, at the time of death, will be reborn in the world of Sukhāvatī.

If someone merely hears the name of this stūpa, then after death they will attain the path to unsurpassable, perfect awakening. Even birds, deer, and other such sentient beings that simply see it — when their lives pass, they will leave behind the states of rebirth among animals and will obtain a body endowed with merit.

Whoever wishes to practice the six perfections in their entirety should, as before, prepare a square maṇḍala, smear it with earth and plaster, and then anoint its surface with a solution of fragrant incense. At each of the four corners of the maṇḍala, place a vessel filled with perfumed water. Write out one of the four secret mantras taught previously ninety-nine times, then with one's own hands erect ninety-nine small stūpas, placing one written mantra inside each of them. Then write this mantra out ninety-nine times in letters and insert it into the discs of the stūpas. Set the stūpas upon the maṇḍala, make offerings with flowers and unguents, circumambulate them seven times each in sets of seven, and recite this mantra:

Namas tābhyāṃ tathāgatagaṅgādīvālukakoṭīniyutaśatasahasrāṇām — oṃ bori caraṇi cari mori gori calabāri svāhā.

By performing the ritual in this way, not only will one practice the six perfections in their entirety — one will have, in effect, built stūpas of precious substances as numerous as the grains of sand in hundreds of thousands and tens of millions of Ganges rivers. One will have made offerings and paid

homage to fully and perfectly awakened buddhas numbering ninety-nine times hundreds of thousands and tens of millions. Above and beyond this, all the gods will gather clouds of diverse offerings and supply the stūpa with every kind of requisite, adorning the Tathāgata's palace with manifold provisions and making offerings therein. All those perfectly enlightened buddhas, numbering as many as stated, will know and see this and will bestow their blessing. They will cause that son or daughter of good family to obtain the extensive roots of virtue and all qualities of that great merit.

Furthermore, if someone writes down this king of secret mantras with its essence intact, recites it constantly, performs acts of offering, and wears it upon the body, that very vidyā will guard and protect them. All adversarial enemies, all malevolent beings, yakṣas, rākṣasas, hungry ghosts, and all others of that kind will be unable to cause harm; seized with fear and terror, they will scatter in all directions.

One who merely converses with the reciter of this vidyā will also be thoroughly purified of the karmic obscurations of the five acts of immediate retribution. If someone hears the sound of that mantra-holder's voice, is touched by that person's shadow, or even comes into bodily contact with them, all the karmic obscurations and sins of that person's other lifetimes will be thoroughly purified.

As for the one who recites this vidyā: no poison can harm that person's body; no fire can harm them; no water can carry them away; no spirit of any kind can find an opening; no lightning can strike them. All the buddhas will guard and protect them, and their eyes will cherish and sustain them. All the gods and all those of sacred commitment will render assistance to that person, and no other vidyā, sorcery, or spell of any kind will be able to affect them.

Therefore, wherever the one who recites the vidyā may dwell, they should attend diligently to the rites of this mantra. If the mantra is written in letters and a stūpa is made at a crossroads where four roads meet, or where three roads meet — a place where many people come and go — and the mantra is placed inside it, then all beings, birds, insects, and even ants and worms that see it, hear it, or come into contact with it, or that are touched by the ground beneath it, by its dust, by the wind that has blown past it, or by its shadow — all such beings will be freed from every sin by which they might fall into the animal realm, the realm of hungry ghosts, the lower realms of misfortune, or the hell realms. When the moment of death comes, they will be born among

the gods in the higher realms of happy existence. Because the karmic obscurations of their past lives will have been completely purified, they will attain the recollection of their former births life after life, and they will become possessed of the quality of non-regression.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the great bodhisattva (bodhisattva mahāsattva) Sarva-Nivaraṇa-Viṣkambhin — the one who clears away all obscurations — and to Vajrapāṇi, lord of secrets, and to the four great kings, and to Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, and to the gods of the Brahmā heavens, and to the Great Lord (Maheśvara) and the other gods, and declared: O noble beings, I now entrust to you all this very essence of the king of mantras. Always honor it and uphold it. Place it within a precious casket, proclaim it in every land, and without ever letting the stream be cut, reveal it to sentient beings. If beings are made to see it and to hear it, even the sins of the five acts of immediate consequence will be purified.

Then the great bodhisattva Sarva-Nivaraṇa-Viṣkambhin, Vajrapāṇi lord of secrets, the four great kings, Brahmā, the Great Lord, Viṣṇu (Nārāyaṇa), the gods, the nāgas, the yakṣas, the rākṣasas, the asuras, the great nāgas (mahoragas), and all the rest prostrated at the feet of the Blessed One, and with one voice they spoke and made this request: Blessed One, since the Blessed One, out of loving concern for us, has taught the rites of this mantra and the rites for constructing stūpas just as they have been set forth — and since the Blessed One has declared that any sentient being who, in the future, hears this enumeration of these Dharma categories, takes it to heart, and thereby comes to be freed from all misfortune, all lower rebirths, the hells, and all other sins — we, in order to receive with the crown of our heads the gracious command of the Blessed One, will honor these rites of the mantra, respect them, uphold them, and regard them with the attitude of a precious jewel. We will spread them widely. We will regard them as equal to the face of the Blessed One itself. We will earnestly endeavor that they never decline, and that by every means they may flourish and be disseminated.

When they had spoken these words, the Blessed One declared: O noble beings, it is excellent, truly excellent, and altogether excellent, that you, abiding by your sacred commitments (samaya), have accepted the charge to guard, to honor, and to uphold these rites of the mantra.

When the Blessed One had thus spoken, all those in that retinue rejoiced, and they praised what the Blessed One had taught.

This completes the dhāraṇī known as the Noble Pure Radiance of Stainless Rays of Light.

This text was translated from Sanskrit by the Indian preceptor Vīyākarasiṃha and, as the great translator, the monk Palgyilhunpodé, who revised and established the final rendering. The Lord Atiśa and the spiritual teacher Dromtönpa subsequently retranslated the mantra passages to make them pure and accurate.

Translator's Notes

- The title given in Sanskrit transliteration corresponds to the dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-raśmi-vimalā-viśuddhaprabhā-nāma-dhāraṇī, a text in the genre of luminosity dhāraṇīs associated with purification of negative karma. The opening colophon indicates this passage was excerpted from the Bodhyagryābharaṇaśatasāhasra, a large compendium dhāraṇī collection; the Sanskrit reconstruction of that title is approximate.

The term rendered "Kapilavastu-moon" for the brahmin's name follows the Tibetan literally: Ser-skya'i zla-ba, meaning "Moon of Kapilavastu." This is an unusual personal name and may reflect a proper name derived from the city name.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as this is an excerpt. No closing is supplied.

- The bodhisattva's name, rendered here as Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin, means "Remover of All Obscurations." The text gives the Tibetan equivalent Sgrib pa thams cad rnam par sel ba, which is a standard translation of this Sanskrit name.

The epithet Vimalaprabhā rendered as "Immaculate and Pure Radiance" translates the Tibetan Dri ma med cing rnam par dag pa'i 'od. This appears to be the name of the mantra or the dhāraṇī text itself rather than a deity, and it is treated accordingly.

- The mantra is transliterated as it appears in the Tibetan, which reflects a Sanskrit dhāraṇī in Tibetan phonetic rendering. Minor phonetic variations from standard Sanskrit are expected in such transmissions and have been rendered faithfully rather than normalized.

The term rendered "three white foods" refers to the traditional Buddhist list of milk, yogurt, and butter.

- The phrase rendered "lord of the assembly" translates རྒྱལ་ཁོངས་ཀྱི་ལོན་པོ་, which in ritual contexts typically refers to Gaṇapati (Gaṇeśa), the deity associated with removal of obstacles and presiding over assemblies. The translation preserves the literal rendering; a specialist reader would recognize the referent.

The term རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ is rendered "spirits (bhūtas)" following the Sanskrit bhūta, a class of non-human beings.

- The figure "ninety-nine thousand" renders the Tibetan dgu khri dgu stong, literally "nine ten-thousands and nine thousands," i.e. 99,000. This is a standard formula of great numerical merit in stūpa consecration texts.

The divine name Dharmabhadra (Chos bzang lha, lit. "the god of Excellent Dharma") is a relatively obscure deity invoked as a reference point for a magnificent celestial temple; the passage compares the merit of this ritual to building a temple-stūpa in that deity's divine presence. The identification is not entirely certain and is noted accordingly.

- The term rendered "forefather who protects the world" translates the Tibetan literally:

Brahmā as the ancestral protector deity of the world. The pair Viṣṇu and the Great God (Śiva) appear here by their usual Tibetan epithets meaning "all-pervading" and "great lord" respectively. The figure of Yama as "lord of death" and Varuṇa as "water deity" are rendered by their functional epithets in context. The figure count of buddhas — "ninety-nine hundred million million" — renders a compound Tibetan large-number term that is genuinely difficult to resolve with precision; the translation follows the most natural reading of the stacked numerical expressions.

- The mantra passage is transliterated Sanskrit embedded in the Tibetan text and is rendered here as transliterated Sanskrit rather than translated, following standard practice for dhāraṇī and mantra texts. Minor orthographic variations in the Tibetan transliteration have been normalized to standard Sanskrit where recoverable.

The bodhisattva's name Sarvanivaraṇaṣkambhin (Tibetan: Sribpa Tamché Nampar Selwa) is rendered in Sanskrit as it appears in the house glossary under that deity's standard designation.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, reflecting that this is a continuous excerpt; the translation trails off accordingly.

- The title "lord of all yakṣas and master of secrets" renders Vajrapāṇi's epithet here, which is his standard role in tantric literature as chief of the yakṣas and guardian of secret teachings. The phrase "body of the Secret One" for the nine-thousand recitation refers to an identification of the mantra-lord with Vajrapāṇi's own form as the guhyapati, the lord of secrets.
- The mantra text is left in transliterated Sanskrit as found in the Tibetan; the syllables are a liturgical formula and are not translated.

The term rendered "sons of Mṛtyu" translates Tibetan བླ་མ་གྲོ་མེད་ཀྱི་བུ་ཆེན་པོ་།, literally "sons of the Desireless One" — a Tibetan calque of the Sanskrit Mārtya or Nirmṛtyu; in context these are likely a class of semi-divine beings associated with death. The identification is not entirely certain but the rendering is chosen to convey the supernatural context.

The word *kṛsara* (rice-and-legume porridge) is a Sanskrit culinary term preserved in the Tibetan transliteration; it is left in Sanskrit with a brief gloss.

- The mantra text is reproduced phonetically as it appears in the Tibetan, normalized to standard transliteration. The opening phrase likely corresponds to a Sanskrit salutation to tathāgatas as numerous as the sands of the Ganges in their hundreds of thousands and tens of millions of koṭis and niyutas; the precise reconstruction of the opening "Namas tābhyām" may reflect a corrupt or abbreviated transmission.

The phrase rendered "their eyes will cherish and sustain them" translates a construction meaning the buddhas watch over the practitioner with the eye of compassionate care; it could also be read as "they will be sustained by the eye" — i.e., by Avalokiteśvara — which would suit the context of the broader text.

- The term rendered "Viṣṇu (Nārāyaṇa)" translates Tibetan "sred med kyi bu," literally "son of Narayana" or "son of the Desire-less one," a standard Tibetan epithet for Viṣṇu-Nārāyaṇa; the translation makes this identification explicit for the listener. The assembly list here is notably comprehensive, including both divine and wrathful classes of beings as witnesses and guardians of the teaching. The phrase "the five acts of immediate consequence" refers to the five ānantarya-karmas, the gravest possible misdeeds in Buddhist teaching, whose purification by this dhāraṇī underscores the extraordinary power attributed to the text.
- The name rendered as Vīyākarasiṃha is a phonetic Tibetan transcription of a Sanskrit name, the exact form of which admits some variation in scholarly reconstruction. The monk's name Palgyilhunpodé is likewise a Tibetan name rendered in approximate phonetic English.

Dromtönpa refers to the celebrated Tibetan disciple of Atiśa, Dromtön Gyalwai Jungné, who is consistently identified by this title in the tradition.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.